

Learn Copywriting: Beginner's Guide

Lesson 5: Benefits vs. Features

Benefits vs. Features – Study Notes

Key Concepts

1. **Feature** !' Attribute of a product or service – what it *does* or *has*.
2. **Benefit** !' Value to the customer – why that feature *matters* to them.
3. **Feature to Benefit translation** – the skill of converting a technical detail into a compelling customer advantage.
4. **Customer focused language** – using “you” and outcome oriented phrasing to highlight benefits.
5. **Why it matters** – benefits drive purchasing decisions; features alone rarely persuade.

Summary

A **feature** describes a characteristic of a product (e.g., “12 hour battery life”). While factual, it tells the buyer little about how the product improves their life. A **benefit** answers the hidden question, “What’s in it for me?” By linking the feature to a concrete outcome (“you can work all day without recharging”), the message becomes relevant, memorable, and persuasive.

The process of turning features into benefits involves three steps:

1. **Identify the feature** – list the technical or functional attribute.
2. **Ask “so what?”** – determine the direct effect of that attribute on the user.
3. **Phrase it as a benefit** – use customer centric language that emphasizes the positive result.

Mastering this translation is essential for anyone creating marketing copy, sales pitches, or product descriptions, especially at the beginner level where the focus is on clear, simple communication.

Important Points

- **Features are facts; benefits are emotions + outcomes.**
- Always start with the **customer's need or pain point** before presenting the benefit.
- Use **active, vivid verbs** (“stay powered”, “finish projects faster”).
- Keep benefits **specific and measurable** when possible (e.g., “12 hour battery = 8 extra meetings”).
- In copy, place the benefit **before** the feature for stronger impact (Benefit !' Feature).
- Practice the **“So what?”** question repeatedly until the benefit feels natural.

Examples

Feature	Benefit (converted)	Explanation
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| **Battery lasts 12 /hours** | **Work all day without hunting for an outlet** | The benefit ties the long battery to uninterrupted productivity, a real need for most users. |

| **Water resistant to 5 /m** | **Take your phone on a swim or rainy commute without worry** | Shows the user how the specification protects their device in everyday scenarios. |

How the conversion works:

1. Identify the feature.
2. Ask: "What does this allow the user to do?"
3. Phrase it with "you" and an outcome.

Quick Review

1. **What is the main difference between a feature and a benefit?**
2. **Why do customers care more about benefits than features?**
3. **What question helps you turn a feature into a benefit?**
4. **Rewrite this feature as a benefit: "LED display with 1080p resolution."**
5. **In a sales sentence, which should come first: the benefit or the feature?**

Further Reading

- **Copywriting Basics:** Headline formulas that highlight benefits.
- **Customer Personas:** Understanding needs to craft relevant benefits.
- **AIDA Model:** How benefits fit into Attention Interest Desire Action.
- **Storytelling in Marketing:** Turning benefits into narratives.

Use these notes to practice converting product specs into customer focused advantages. The more you internalize the "so what?" mindset, the more persuasive your communication will become.

